



YOU ARE **16 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

164 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this 2-D ultrasound, the baby's head is to the left, with the arms not visible, although the knee and lower leg can be seen. At this stage, details of the brain developing under the skull are becoming much more apparent.

“Until you feel your baby move, hearing his heartbeat is the next best way for you to bond with him.”

At this stage of pregnancy, your doctor may be able to hear your baby's heartbeat using a handheld Doppler ultrasound machine. Because ultrasound waves do not travel well in air, gel is applied to the end of the probe or “transducer” as it is placed on your abdomen. This then detects the heartbeat and converts it into a sound that we can hear.

It's quite easy to distinguish your baby's heartbeat from your own since it beats almost twice as fast. However, your baby's heart rate peaked around five weeks ago and, since then, has slowed down as the nerves controlling the heart's rhythm have matured.

During the second half of pregnancy, the range of the heartbeat is between 110 and 160 beats per minute and will be responsive to many stimuli, as well as to your baby's activity.

HEART RATE AND GENDER

The baby's heart rate is not an indication of gender. A study in the mid-1990s, using over 10,000 measurements, dispelled the theory that the speed of a baby's heartbeat predicted whether it would be a boy or a girl.